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INFLUENCE AND PERCEPTION MANAGEMENT OFFICE
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WASHINGTON, DC 20301-5000
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Department of Defense
OFFICE OF PREPUBLICATION AND SECURITY REVIEW

MEMORANDUM FOR 2022 NOTRE DAME NATIONAL SECURITY INNOVATION
COURSE STUDENTS AND FACULTY

SUBJECT: Challenge for 2022 University of Notre Dame National Security Innovation Course

- On 01 March 2022, per direction from the Secretary of Defense (SecDef) and Under Secretary of Defense for Intelligence and Security (USD(I&S)), the Influence and Perception Management Office (IPMO) was established. Among other things, the IPMO is tasked with the development of broad thematic messaging guidance and specific strategies for the execution of DoD activities designed to influence foreign defense-related decision-makers to behave in a manner beneficial to U.S. interests.
- Challenge: At the front-end (during strategy development or even operational planning stages), how might the Defense Intelligence Enterprise (DIE) or broader Intelligence Community (IC) identify key influencers in a given area, country or region, including the most common/preferred platforms used to send/receive messages? At the back-end (during or after execution of influence activities), how might the DIE or IC measure the effectiveness of DoD influence activities conducted (in the near term or over long periods of time)?
- Illustrative example: Let's say DoD wants to influence Country A's leaders to stop purchasing a weapon system from Country B (because we believe the continued purchasing might jeopardize DoD's military advantage, in some way, if the U.S. ever had to engage in armed conflict with Country A). Assuming the IPMO has worked to establish the desired perceptions of leaders from Country A and B which would lead to this desired behavior change, how might key influencers be identified that have sway over these leaders' thought processes, beliefs, motives, reasoning, etc. (including ascertaining their typical modes and methods of communication)? Thereafter, assuming an influence strategy is developed, how might the DIE or IC determine if DoD's influence activities are working (aside from waiting and watching hopefully that Country A eventually stops purchasing the weapons system in question from Country B)?
- My staff and I look forward to discussing these concepts and answering any questions students may have. Please note that IPMO personnel participating in any events associated with this course are expressing their personal thoughts, opinions, and observations, which do not necessarily represent the official positions of the DoD.

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